



Figure 7: Web conferencing with Moodle and BigBlueButton

of BigBlueButton server. However, if you are interested in further details about setting up such a server, you can download the detailed installation steps compiled by one of the authors (Manoj) from the following link: opensourceforu.com/article_source_code/Oct20Moodleplugins.zip.

If you have any doubts regarding these installation steps, we will be glad to address them. But what is the need for such a step-by-step installation, if there is an easy way? For one thing, hosting servers is always tedious and anything could go wrong if you solely depend on a shell script. But that is not the only reason why you should try setting up the server using a step-by-step process. Learning management systems like Moodle are often developed to simulate real world classrooms where the strength is usually between 10 and 100. They are not meant to run MOOCs (Massive Open

Online Courses). Therefore, when you try to run Web conferences with BigBlueButton on Moodle, the usual upper limit for concurrent users is around 200. If you want to go much beyond this limit, you need to have multiple servers in parallel. In such situations, you need a load balancer called Scalelite, which makes a number of BigBlueButton servers appear at the front-end as a single powerful BigBlueButton server. We believe that the first step to any such expansion is a manual setting up of a single normal BigBlueButton server.

We are sure that our readers are convinced about the abilities of Moodle and BigBlueButton to provide ample services for setting up Web conferences to conduct online classes effectively. With some effort and patience, the combined might of Moodle and BigBlueButton will allow you to simulate a real class environment to a great extent.

In the next article in this series, we plan to address teachers of a younger audience where we will discuss Moodle plugins like MooTyper, which can be used to create interactive online content for school-level courses. **END** 🐧

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